

BUBBLE TEA

This flavored fruit or milk tea gets its name from its chewy tapioca bubbles, also known as “boba,” which add texture, sweetness, and visual appeal. Bubble tea originated in Taiwan in the early 1980s and has since gained popularity worldwide as a versatile and fun beverage.

HOW TO MAKE TARO BUBBLE TEA

This popular frothy drink gets its lovely purple color and milkshake-like consistency from its fibrous taro liquid base. Tapioca pearls add a fun element to this easy recipe. Made from tapioca starch, these soft, chewy, and slightly sweet bubbles sink to the bottom of the tumbler and can only be drawn up through a fat straw.

YOU WILL NEED

Ingredients

5½oz (150g) 5-minute tapioca pearls (will yield enough boba for 4 servings)

1 cup sugar

7oz (200g) taro root, peeled and chopped

honey or sugar, to sweeten

Special equipment

handheld blender



1 In a large saucepan, bring 2 quarts of water to a boil and add the tapioca pearls. Simmer for 1–2 minutes until the pearls rise to the surface and start to soften. Reduce to medium heat, cover, and simmer for 5 minutes.



2 Remove the boba with a slotted spoon and place in a bowl of cold water to prevent them from sticking together. Boil 1 cup water with the sugar for 2 minutes. Cool, then soak the boba in the sugar syrup for 15 minutes.



TARO ROOT

The versatile taro root can be roasted, boiled, or baked, and is rich in potassium and fiber.



3 For the taro liquid, boil the taro root in 2 cups water for 20 minutes, or until soft. Remove from the heat and drain. Blend the taro, adding fresh water, or milk, to get to drinking consistency. Sweeten to taste with honey or sugar. Pour into 2 tumblers and add one-quarter of the prepared boba to each.